MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 11-13-2024

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
October 16, 2024

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

District 3 Samantha Pitchford and District 9 Rick Fancon

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott and members of the public

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Gilmore to approve the agenda with additions, **motion carried**

*Additions
Under Public Hearings/Special Presentation add Dewayne Rogers to item b

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of September 18, 2024 and September 30, 2024, **motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

Members of the public spoke regarding their support for the Road Commission's request to build a new building.

Members of the public spoke regarding their dissatisfaction with how the defunding of the county-owned airport was handled, specifically by not including the Airport Committee and with no discussion with the people and businesses that have signed leases with Clare County that are directly affected by the defunding of the airport.

Multiple members of the public spoke that purchased property in Clare County specifically because of the County Airport.

Members of the public spoke in support of defunding the county-owned airport and do not feel that it will bring people to the County, referenced the fact that the County does not support the City of Clare owned airport.

The owner of the Airport Restaurant spoke regarding how defunding the County owned airport will affect her business, the people she employes the Clare County residents that frequent her restaurant and the people from out of town that fly in and drive into Clare County to spend their money here. She also questioned of who is going to compensate her for the 10-years of lost business, sighting that she just signed a 10-year contract with Clare County to lease the building that houses her restaurant.

One member of the public offered to research and talk on behalf of the Clare County to inquire if an agreement can be made between City of Harrison, Hayes Township and Clare County to jointly fund the County owned airport.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT - continued

Comparisons were made between the Clare County Airport, the Oakland County Airport and the City of Clare Airport.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

a. Resolution Opposing Use of State Lands By Camp Grayling- Crawford County – No discussion
b. Resolution Opposing Livingston County Policy To Monitor and Document Contacts Between Undocumented Immigrants and The Livingston County Sheriff's Office- Washtenaw County – No discussion
c. Environmental Corporation of America – No discussion
d. Correspondence to Mr. Raymond Elliott – No discussion
e. Resolution Requesting Issuance of Bonds- Clare County Road Commission – No discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

None

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Equalization – Pete Preston – Apportionment Report
It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to accept the Apportionment Report as presented and authorize the Equalization Director to spread the tax toll, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Housler, Majewski, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Kleinhardt and Haskell
Nays: (0)
Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Pitchford
Motion carried

2. Eric McGlothlin, Dickenson Wright – Bond Counsel, Andy Campbell, Bendzinski & Co. – Registered Municipal Advisor and Dewayne Rogers – Clare County Road Commission Manager

Manager Rogers, Mr. McGlothlin and Mr. Campbell spoke regarding the process of using a public bond to build a new facility for the Road Commission that is compliant with all state laws.

a. It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to adopt Resolution #24-19, Intent to Issue Limited Tax General Obligation Bonds, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Housler, Majewski, Gilmore, Kleinhardt and Haskell
Nays: (0)
Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Pitchford
Motion carried

b. It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the contract with Bendzinski & Co. as Municipal Finance Advisors to provide guidance and time structure of the debt as outlined in the contract, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Majewski, Housler, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Kleinhardt and Haskell
Nays: (0)
Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Pitchford
Motion carried

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS - continued

c. It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the Agreement between Clare County and Dickenson Wright as legal representation to the County as the issuer of bonds, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Housler, Hoefling, Gilmore, Kleinhardt and Haskell
Nays: (0)
Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Pitchford
Motion carried

JUSTICE

1. Animal Control
It was moved by Commissioner Gilmore, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to increase the euthanasia expense from $45.00 per procedure to $55.00 per procedure, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Gilmore, Majewski, Housler, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Kleinhardt and Haskell
Nays: (0)
Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Pitchford
Motion carried

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Materials Management
It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to appoint Keith Hayes from Waste Management to the Materials Management Committee, **motion carried**

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of September 16, 2024 in the amount of $73,003.22 and the meeting minutes of September 30, 2024 in the amount of $303,318.63, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Housler, Hoefling, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Kleinhardt and Haskell
Nays: (0)
Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Pitchford
Motion carried

2. Monthly Expenditures
It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the expenditures for the month of September, 2024, in the amount of $3,161,170.36 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $851,537.68, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Hoefling, Housler, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Kleinhardt and Haskell
Nays: (0)
Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Pitchford
Motion carried

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION - continued

3. Personnel
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to ratify the wage opener agreement ratified by the following bargaining units, The International Union, United Automobile, Aerospace & Agricultural Implement Workers of America and UAW, Units 3, 4, and 5 of its Local Union No. 1974, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Housler, Hoefling, Gilmore, Kleinhardt and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Pitchford
   Motion carried

4. Cost Allocation Plan
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to renew the Master Services Agreement between MGT Impact Solutions, LLC and Clare County to provide the required annual Cost Allocation Plan, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Hoefling, Housler, Majewski, Gilmore, Kleinhardt and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (2) being Commissioners Fancon and Pitchford
   Motion carried

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

Clerk and Register of Deeds Lori Mott gave an update regarding absentee voting and early voting for the November 5, 2024 Election.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners. Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger gave updates regarding the Supreme Court Ruling on Schaffer vs Kent County, the last land auction in which all parcels were sold, the new dog licenses for 2025 that are now available as requested by the snowbirds and the reconciliation of year end 2024. Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger ended by inviting the Commissioner's to meet with her to answer any of their questions.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman Jeff Haskell attended a career quest held by Clare County Michigan Works and Great Lakes Bay Michigan Works. There were 45 employers and 5,000 students in attendance. Chairman Haskell feels that there should be discussion at next committee of the whole and answer questions regarding the County owned airport that were raised during public comment.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Dale Majewski has been attending his meetings and discussed a bill in the House regarding septic inspections and invited everyone to attend an open house at the Lincoln Township Fire Department on October 31, 2024.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Housler has attended her meetings and offered no report.

Commissioner Hoefling has attended his meetings and gave a report on each of the townships and committees he serves. Commissioner Hoefling additionally gave notice of new Firefighter training being offered in Clare County.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis announced the next Airport Committee Meeting date, time and location.

Commissioner Gilmore attended both his township meetings and commented there was nothing important to report.

Commissioner Kleinhardt attend his township meetings and offered no report.

STATE OF THE COUNTY BUDGET

No report.

PUBLIC COMMENT

Clare County Road Commission Manager Dewayne Rogers offered to meet and have discussions regarding the potential use of Road Commission equipment to help with the airport and eliminate some of the Commissioner's concerns regarding the County owned airport.

There were additional comments regarding the differences between the County owned airport and the airport owned by the City of Clare, the consequences of giving up the airport that has been in existence since 1937 and never being able to get it back, suggestions regarding ways to fund the airport and the possibility of making the airport private and not a public airport.

Questions arose regarding the next committee meeting regarding ambulance services for Clare County. No meeting is currently scheduled.

There were comments regarding dissatisfaction and fiscal irresponsibility with the Commissioner's 7-2 vote at the last meeting to pay a company out of Grand Rapids for Clare County ballot programming instead of keeping it in house and in county and pay the County Clerk a stipend to continue the ballot programming at a fraction of the cost.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

Meeting Adjourned at 10:05 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

Jeff Haskell, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners